

How an order gets in, and how the money gets to you

Every shirt is made to order right now, and nothing is charged up front. An order starts one of three ways, the shirt gets made, and only when it's ready to ship does the customer get a Stripe link. Read it top to bottom: the rows are the stages every order goes through, the columns are the three ways one can start.

The one rule: make first, ask for the money when it's ready to ship, ship when it's paid. The site collects the request and the address; Stripe collects the money; the two meet when you flip the order to Paid.

 You do this by hand

 Money moves

 The site does this on its own

CUSTOMER

THE SITE

YOU

STRIPE

 who's acting

Stage	Lineup shirt	Custom design	Off the site
top to bottom	Order request from the site	Request from /custom	Market, DM, text
	LIVE TODAY	LIVE TODAY	LIVE TODAY
1 The order starts Three doors in, no money yet	CUSTOMER Picks a design, color, and size on the site, taps Order this one, fills in name, email, and address, sends the request.  THE SITE Saves it as Awaiting payment, emails you (Reply goes straight to the customer), phone push, and emails the customer a copy.	CUSTOMER Fills in /custom: leaves, a logo, a graphic, or something else, with the artwork attached.  THE SITE Saves the request and the artwork file, emails you, phone push.	CUSTOMER DMs on Instagram, texts, or walks up at a market table.

Stage	Lineup shirt	Custom design	Off the site
top to bottom	Order request from the site	Request from /custom	Market, DM, text
	LIVE TODAY	LIVE TODAY	LIVE TODAY
2 You confirm One reply, no link yet	 YOU Reply to the order email: got it, here's roughly when it will be ready. Nothing to pay yet.	 YOU Reply with a quote: price, blank, timeline. Customer says yes and mails the leaves if it's a leaf piece.	 YOU Agree the design, color, size, and price in person or by message.
3 The shirt gets made 1 to 2 weeks, depending on the queue	 YOU Make the shirt. Flip the order to Made in /admin so you can see what's in the queue.	 YOU Cut the stencil or lay the leaves, make it.	 YOU Make it, or it's already on the table at a market.
4 Ready to ship: the ask This is where Stripe comes in	 YOU Send a Stripe payment link (or invoice): your shirt is ready, here's the total with \$7 shipping. STRIPE Hosted link page with card, Apple Pay, Google Pay; receipt sent automatically.	 YOU Send a Stripe invoice for the quoted amount. STRIPE Invoice email with a Pay button; reminders if it sits unpaid.	 YOU Payment link (paste it or show the QR) or Tap to Pay in the Stripe app on your iPhone.
5 Paid Money moves, and the cost is frozen	\$ CUSTOMER Pays the link.  YOU Flip the order to Paid in /admin. That flip is the moment the shirt's cost is frozen in Sales history.	\$ CUSTOMER Pays the invoice.  YOU Custom pieces aren't orders in the admin, so add it in Sales history → Record a sale as a custom piece with the price and date.	\$ CUSTOMER Pays.  YOU Sales history → Record a sale : design, color, size, price, date, and where it sold.

Stage	Lineup shirt	Custom design	Off the site
top to bottom	Order request from the site	Request from /custom	Market, DM, text
	LIVE TODAY	LIVE TODAY	LIVE TODAY
6 Shipped or handed over	 YOU Ship it, email the tracking number, flip the order to Shipped . Type the postage on the row in Sales history.	 YOU Ship it, email tracking. Postage on the row.	 YOU Hand it over, or ship it.
7 Payout Stripe → your bank, minus the card fee	 STRIPE Pays out to the bank on Stripe's schedule. Type the fee on the row if you want net margin exact; the site only sees fees on its own card checkout.	 STRIPE Pays out to the bank, minus the card fee and the 0.4% invoice fee.	 STRIPE Pays out to the bank, minus the card fee.

Why the flip to Paid matters

The site never hears about a payment link or invoice being paid. When you flip an order to **Paid** in /admin, two things happen: the customer's order is marked as money in, and the shirt's cost is frozen in Sales history with the COGS sheet that's current that day. Do it the day the money lands.

Custom pieces and off site sales

Only lineup requests are orders in the admin. A custom piece or a market sale gets into the history through **Record a sale** on the Sales history page: design (or Custom piece), color, size, price, date, where it sold. Takes a minute, and it's what keeps the margin numbers honest.

Not in play today: Buy now card checkout

The site can sell a shirt by card on the spot when a design has counted stock in /admin/products and the Stripe keys are in Vercel. The lineup has no counted stock, so that door is closed for now. When you make a batch ahead of a drop, enter the counts and it opens on its own, with the cost and Stripe fee recorded automatically.

STAGE 4

Three ways to ask for the money, none of them need code

TOOL	BEST FOR	WHAT THE CUSTOMER GETS	WHAT IT COSTS YOU	WHERE YOU MAKE IT
Stripe payment link	A finished lineup shirt, Instagram DMs, a QR code at a market	A checkout page from a link: card, Apple Pay, Google Pay. It can confirm the shipping address and add the \$7 flat rate	The normal card fee only	Stripe dashboard → Payment links, then paste the link into your reply or show the QR
Stripe invoice	Custom work you've quoted, anything with a due date, repeat customers	An email with line items, a Pay button, a receipt, and automatic reminders if they sit on it	The normal card fee plus 0.4% of the invoice	Stripe dashboard → Invoices, or the Stripe app on your phone
Tap to Pay	In person, someone standing in front of you with a card or phone	Taps their card or phone on your iPhone, gets a text or email receipt	The normal card fee (Stripe's pay as you go Terminal rate)	Stripe Dashboard app on iPhone → + → Charge a card

YOUR PART

Everything the site can't do for you



Reply to each request when it comes in

The order email's reply-to is the customer, so it's one Reply: got it, and roughly when it will be ready. No link yet.



Keep the status moving in /admin

Awaiting payment → Made → Paid → Shipped. Made tells you what's in the queue; Paid is the moment the cost is frozen; Shipped closes it out.



Send the Stripe link the day the shirt is ready

Payment link for lineup shirts, invoice for custom quotes. Same message every time: it's ready, here's the link, it ships the day you pay.



Record custom pieces and off site sales in Sales history

Record a sale on /admin/history takes the design, color, size, price, date, and where it sold, and freezes that day's cost on it.

**Type postage (and the card fee, if you want it exact) on the row**

You charge \$7 flat; what USPS actually charged goes in the Postage box on the Sales history row, so you can see whether shipping is making or losing money.

**Count stock and add the Stripe keys when you want Buy now**

Track stock in /admin/products per color and size, STRIPE_SECRET_KEY and STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET in Vercel (README step 4). The site notices on its own.

Drawn from the site as built in September 2026: split ordering mode with no counted stock, \$7 flat rate shipping, 1 to 2 week making time, sales history with the cost frozen at Paid. Stripe fees from stripe.com/pricing and stripe.com/invoicing/pricing; check them before quoting anyone.